

AN ANALYTICAL STUDY

Social Media Use and Mental Health

How daily screen time and platform choice relate to anxiety, sleep and happiness

Data analysis and design: **Ahmed Elabgari**

500	16–49	6
participants	age range	platforms

Objective

Analyze the possible link between anxiety and the time people spend on social media each day, using survey data that covers demographic and behavioral variables.

What the data covers

Age group and gender, average daily time on social media, most-used platform, anxiety and happiness scores, and sleep quality.

Why it matters

Understanding which usage patterns go with higher anxiety and poorer sleep gives a factual basis for encouraging more balanced use and better digital health.

Raw data source: Kaggle, Social Media and Mental Health Balance

Executive summary

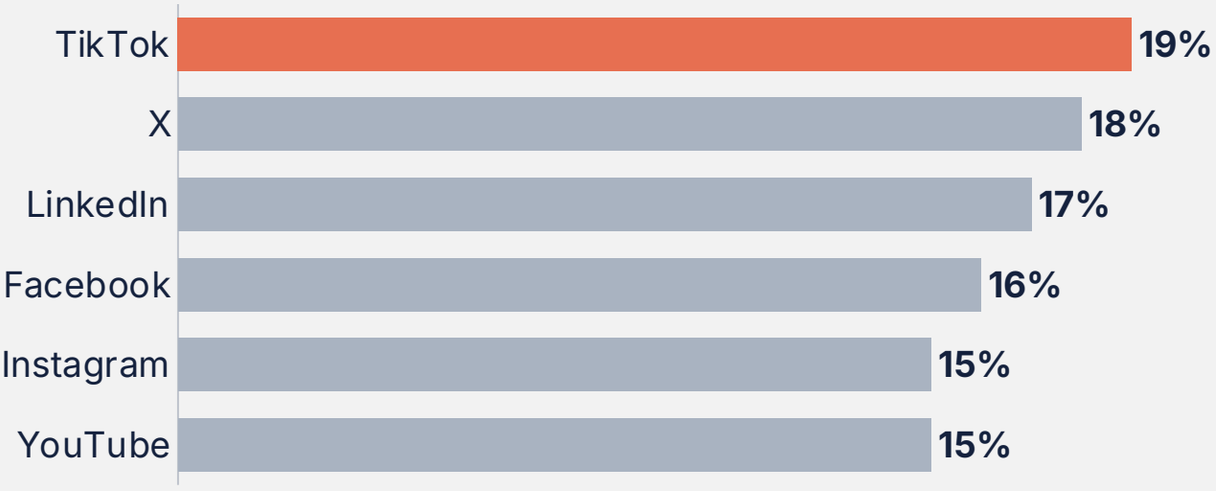
SAMPLE AT A GLANCE

500
participants aged 16–49

5.5 hrs
average daily time on social media

50% / 46%
men / women (5% unspecified)

Platform usage share, % of participants



KEY FINDINGS

1. **Anxiety rises with screen time:** it averages 4.3/10 at 1–2 hrs a day and 8.7/10 at 8–10 hrs.

2. **Instagram users are the most anxious (6.9/10);** X and LinkedIn users the least (6.4/10).

3. **Ages 21–30 and 31–40 sleep worst (6.2/10)** and report the highest anxiety (6.6/10).

4. **Ages 31–40 spend the most time online (5.6 hrs a day);** Facebook is their most-used platform (20%).

RECOMMENDATIONS

Schedule phone time
Set fixed times for phone use and plan a daily break from screens.

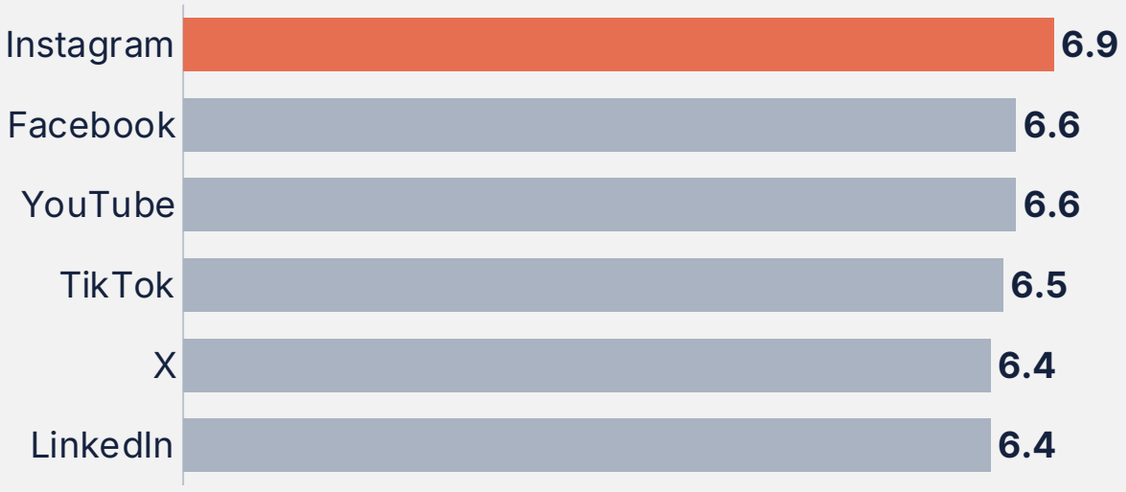
Curate your feed
Unfollow accounts that invite comparison; follow supportive ones.

Under 4 hrs a day
Cap daily use below 4 hours and keep the hour before bed screen-free.

Move offline
Swap some scrolling for time with people or physical activity.

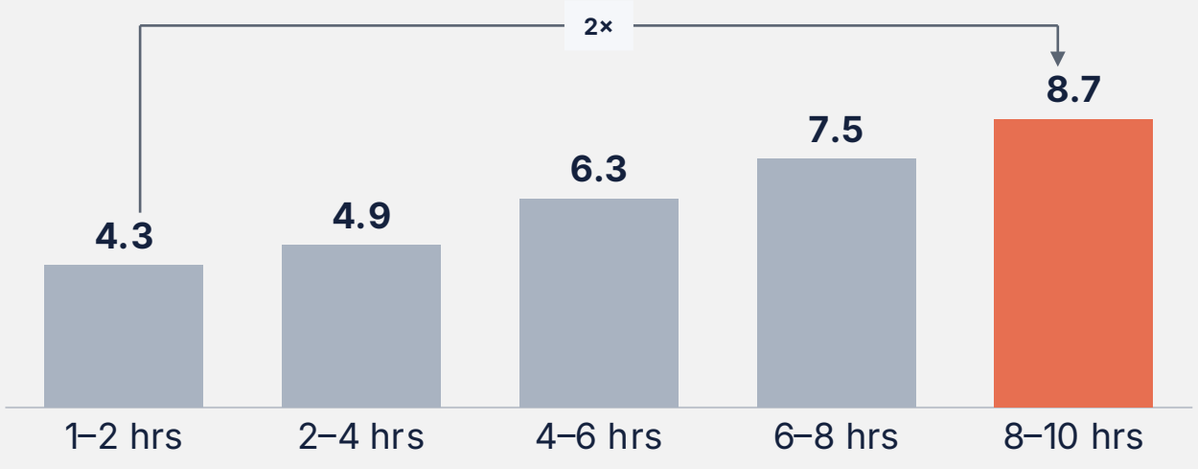
Anxiety doubles with screen time and peaks among Instagram users

Average anxiety score by platform, out of 10



Men on Instagram score 7.0, the highest of any platform and gender; women on Instagram score 6.7.

Average anxiety score by daily time on social media, out of 10



Women are more anxious than men at light use (4.7 vs 3.0 at 1–2 hrs); from 2 hrs a day the gap is 0.3 points or less.

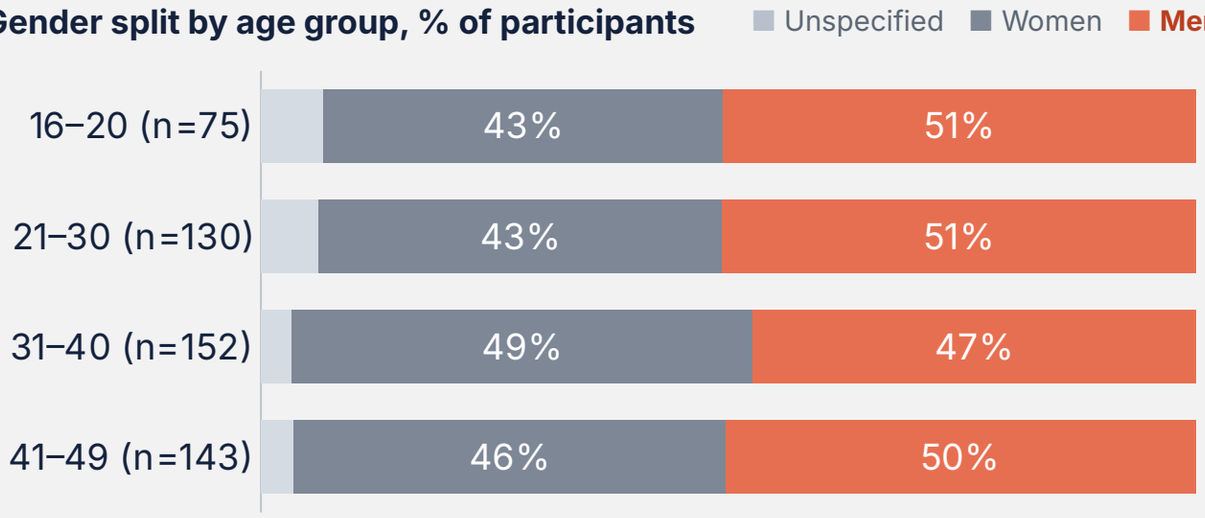
Wellbeing by age group

Age group	Hrs / day	Happiness	Anxiety	Sleep	Exercise / wk
16–20	5.4	8.4	6.4	6.5	**2.0**
21–30	5.4	**8.2**	**6.6**	**6.2**	**2.0**
31–40	**5.6**	8.3	**6.6**	**6.2**	2.5
41–49	5.4	8.4	6.5	6.3	2.5

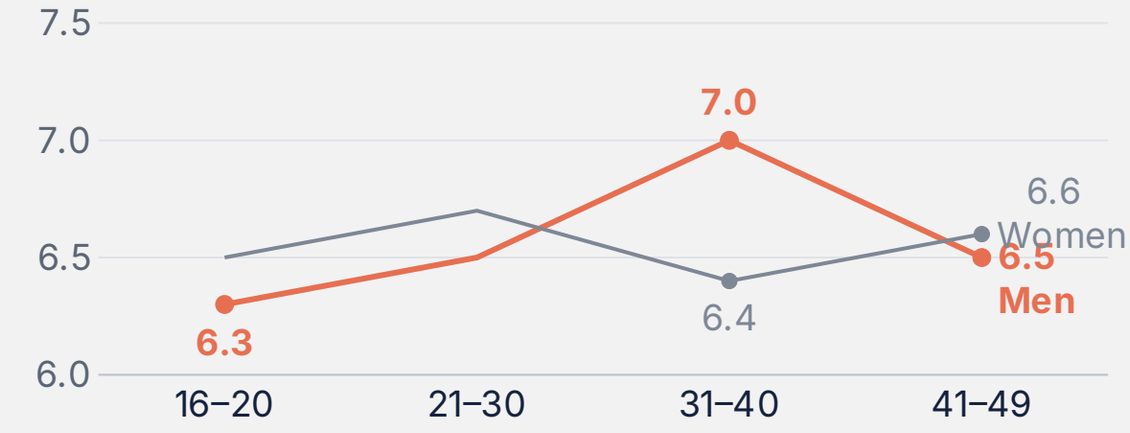
Scores out of 10; exercise is average workouts per week. Coral marks the least favorable value in each column.

Men aged 31–40 report the highest anxiety and the poorest sleep

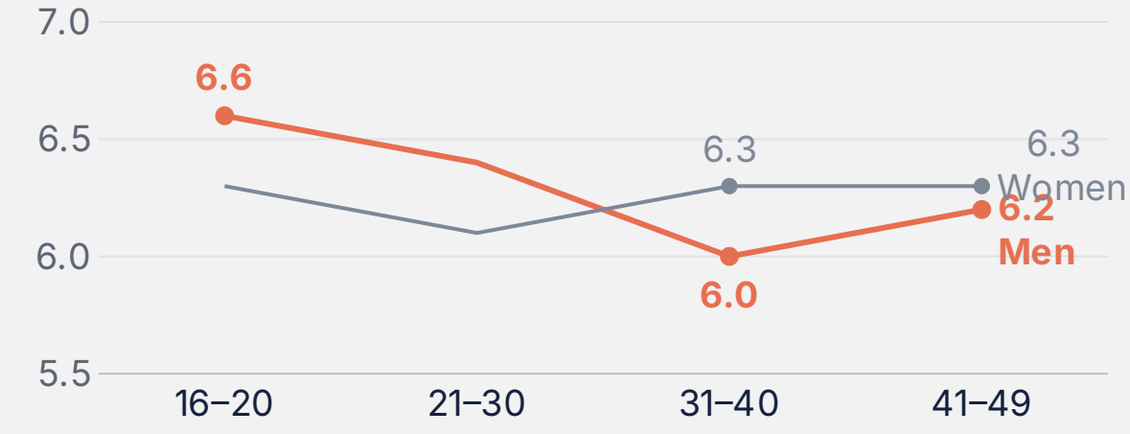
Gender split by age group, % of participants



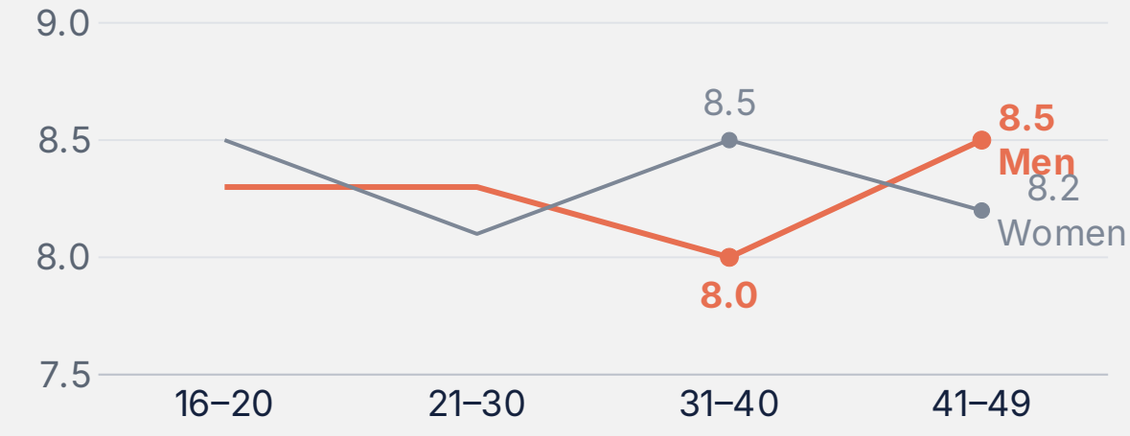
Average anxiety score by age group, out of 10



Average sleep quality by age group, out of 10



Average happiness score by age group, out of 10





SOCIAL MEDIA USE AND MENTAL HEALTH

Thank you

Less time on social media goes with lower anxiety: 4.3/10 at 1–2 hrs a day against 8.7/10 at 8–10 hrs.

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